

Healthcare Spanish Initiative

Free training in culturally authentic medical Spanish for the next generation of healthcare providers, students, and community health workers.

FREE ENROLLMENT

PRE-HEALTH STUDENTS

HEALTHCARE PROVIDERS

COMMUNITY HEALTH WORKERS

RESEARCH-BACKED

THE PROBLEM

Vocabulary isn't enough.

"Me cayó el estómago."

A patient says this — meaning they feel a deep sense of dread or foreboding, communicated through a culturally specific idiom. A provider trained only in medical Spanish hears stomach pain. This gap costs lives.

Medical Spanish programs teach anatomical terms and clinical phrases. That's necessary — but not sufficient. Language barriers in healthcare are not vocabulary problems. They are cultural competence problems. When a patient defers to a family member, describes pain through metaphor, or says "sí" to avoid confrontation rather than to signal understanding, a provider needs more than a glossary.

WHO IT'S FOR

Built for the people on the front lines.

Pre-Health Students

Medical, nursing, PA, and public health students building clinical communication skills early

Healthcare Providers

Physicians, NPs, nurses, and medical assistants serving Spanish-speaking patient populations

Community Health Workers

CHWs and promotores working in community health navigation and patient advocacy

Residents & Fellows

Trainees in clinical settings who need authentic patient communication skills immediately

CURRICULUM — FIVE MODULES

1

Colloquial vs. Clinical: Why the Gap Matters

Introduction to the difference between textbook medical Spanish and the Spanish patients actually speak — with real case examples from clinical encounters.

2

Cultural Communication Norms

Indirect communication, familismo, pain expression through idiom, and avoiding confrontation — the cultural patterns that change what patients mean vs. what they say.

3

Patient Intake & History Taking

Practice authentic intake conversations using language a Spanish-speaking patient would actually use. Includes slang expressions for symptoms, body parts, and feelings.

4

Mental Health & Sensitive Topics

Culturally sensitive approaches to mental health check-ins, including idioms around emotion, indirect disclosure patterns, and stigma navigation in Spanish.

Regional Variation & Demographic Competence

Spanish is not one language. This module covers the major regional differences in slang, expression, and cultural norm across Mexican, Caribbean, and South American Spanish.

Learning Outcomes

- Recognize colloquial symptom expressions patients actually use
- Conduct authentic patient intake conversations in Spanish
- Navigate culturally indirect communication patterns
- Adapt communication for regional and cultural variation

Enroll free — no credit card, no application, no waitlist.

Create a free account and start immediately at makespanishcasual.org

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